

Postfix Algorithms

Algorithm Evaluate (P)

Evaluate a postfix expression P

```
create an empty stack  $S$ ;  
 $index \leftarrow 1$ ;  
while we have not reached the end of  $P$  do  
   $ch \leftarrow P[index]$ ; {store in  $ch$  the next character in  $P$ }  
  if  $ch$  is an operand then  
    push  $ch$  onto  $S$ ;  
  else { $ch$  is an operator}  
     $operand1 \leftarrow$  pop from  $S$ ;  
     $operand2 \leftarrow$  pop from  $S$ ;  
     $answer \leftarrow$  operation  $ch$  performed on  $operand1$  and  $operand2$ ;  
    push  $answer$  onto  $S$ ;  
  end if  
   $index \leftarrow index + 1$ ;  
end while  
 $result \leftarrow$  pop from  $S$ ;  
return  $result$ 
```

Algorithm InfixToPostFix (I)

Transform an infix expression I to a postfix expression P

```
create an empty stack  $S$ ;  
 $P \leftarrow$  empty expression;  
 $index \leftarrow 1$ ;  
while we have not reached the end of  $I$  do  
   $ch \leftarrow I[index]$ ; {store in  $ch$  the next character in  $I$ }  
  if  $ch$  is an operand then  
    append  $ch$  to the end of  $P$ ;  
  else if  $ch$  is a '(' then  
    push  $ch$  onto  $S$ ;  
  else if  $ch$  is a ')' then  
    repeat  
      pop operators from  $S$  and append them to  $P$ ;  
    until a '(' is popped;  
  else { $ch$  is an operator}  
    while  $S$  is not empty and top of  $S$  is not '(' and top of  $S$  is not a lower precedence operator do  
      pop operators from  $S$  and append them to  $P$ ;  
    end while  
    push  $ch$  onto  $S$ ;  
  end if  
   $index \leftarrow index + 1$ ;  
end while
```